Sharini Rao

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Education

University of California, Berkeley Berkeley, CA
B.A. ***Data Science*** *(Domain Emphasis: Cognition)* *Expected May 2027*

- Pursuing **Berkeley Design Innovation Certificate**
- Relevant Coursework: Data Structures (CS 61B), Data & Computational Structures (Data C88C), UI Design & Development (CS 160), Data Visualization (Data 100), Probability & Statistics (Data 140), Data Mining & Analytics (Data 144), Data Engineering (Data 101), INTEGBI 130 (Bio-Inspired Design), Game Theory (Econ 110), Health Economics (PB HLTH 126)

Skills

- Languages: Python, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL (Postgres/MySQL), HTML/CSS, MATLAB
- Frameworks & Tools: Node.js, React, Next.js, Redis, Pusher, REST APIs, JSON APIs, Git, Vercel, Figma
- Product & Design: Needfinding, Usability Testing, WCAG Accessibility, Figma-to-Code Workflows

Experience

Legali AI Berkeley, CA
Software Engineering Intern *May 2026 – Present*

- Shipped 7 production web pages using **Next.js**, **React**, **Node.js**, and **Figma**-to-code workflows, merging 6 PRs in **Git** while maintaining multi-platform code quality.
- Built a 12-question interactive quiz feature end-to-end featuring multi-step state management, **Web Share API** integration, and WCAG-compliant accessibility across 7 languages.

PwC & Center for Youth Justice Berkeley, CA
Data Analytics Consultant (Extern) *Jun 2026 – Present*

- Audited operational youth facility data to identify structural compliance anomalies, building statistical modeling pipelines in **Python** to optimize facility safety protocols and resource distribution.

UC Berkeley Haas School of Business Berkeley, CA
Data Analytics Research Apprentice *Jan 2026 – Present*

- Built automated ETL pipelines in **Python** (**Pandas**) to extract and clean survey datasets for NGO health equity research, cutting manual preprocessing lead time by 4 weeks.
- Analyzed survey responses from 1,200+ participants using **EDA**, producing data visualizations and stakeholder-ready insights that shaped research priorities.

UC Berkeley – Berkeley Imaging Systems Laboratory Berkeley, CA
Undergraduate Researcher, Ti Lab & Conolly Lab *May 2024 – Aug 2026*

- Functionalized magnetic nanoparticles with DNA aptamer biosensors for potassium, dopamine, and other metabolites (Ti Lab).
- Synthesized superparamagnetic/superferromagnetic iron oxide nanoparticles as in vivo MRI tracers, improving magnetic resolution 10-fold; presented findings on DNA-origami-based nanoparticle design (Conolly Lab).

Projects

Fed Up · Real-Time Group Dining Decision App Personal Project

- Designed product in Figma and built full-stack in Next.js with Google OAuth, persisting data in Postgres and building a recommendation engine via Google Places API & Claude API.
- Implemented real-time group voting rooms with shareable codes using Redis and Pusher, enabling synchronized swipe-based voting across concurrent devices.

NutriPath · RAG-Grounded Meal Planning Assistant Personal Project

- Built a retrieval-augmented generation pipeline over clinical rules using sentence-transformer embeddings and cosine search backed by Redis, achieving 72% top-1 / 90% top-3 retrieval accuracy.

Puffin · Browser-Based Drone Simulation Dashboard UI Design Course Project

- Designed and validated a drone simulation dashboard consolidating controls, telemetry, and ROS data, grounded in 4 pilot interviews and 5 think-aloud usability sessions.

Leadership

Society of Women Engineers Berkeley, CA
Evening with Industry Committee *Aug 2025 – Present*

- Organizing Berkeley's largest SWE networking event, coordinating outreach and logistics for 15-20 partner companies, a keynote speaker, and a networking dinner.

UC Berkeley RecWell Berkeley, CA
FitStaff Operations Lead *May 2024 – Present*

- Coordinate daily operations for a high-traffic campus facility, supporting scheduling, task assignment, and workflow organization across multiple staff members.
- Resolve customer issues in real time and maintain consistent facility standards, trusted with shift oversight and operational leadership for 2.5+ years.